into smaller branches called bronchiole, finally leading to small air filled spaces called alveoli which constitute the lungs.

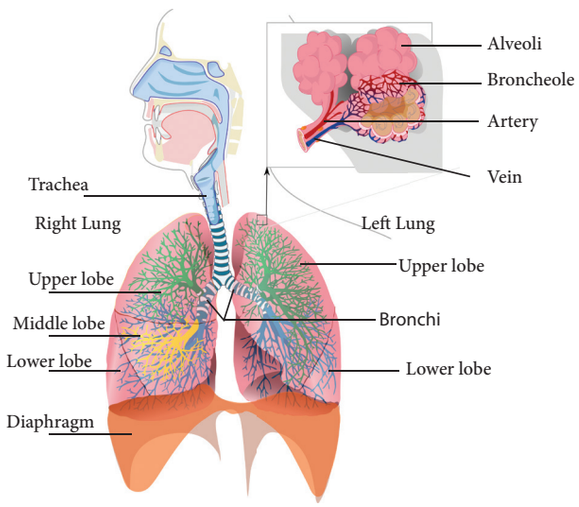
LUNGS

The lungs are two in number, and are cone shaped spongy organs. The base of the lungs rests on the diaphragm, and the apex behind the clavicle, the right lung has 3 lobes and the left lung has 2 lobes.

Each lung is covered by a thin serous membrane called pleura, which is actually made up of 2 layers, between which there is a fluid called as pleural fluid. This act as a lubricant.

The lung is made up of numerous tiny pockets of air sacs called alveoli, which form the main site for exchanges of gases between the inhaled air and the blood.

RESPIRATION

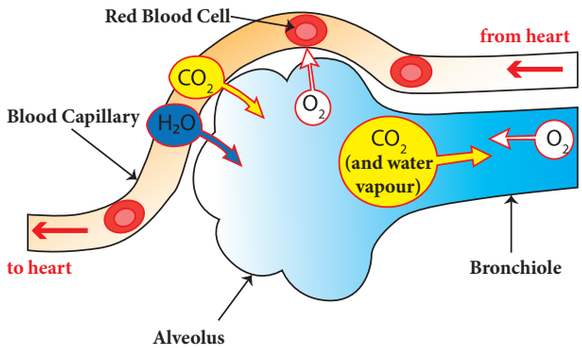


We breathe continuously from birth to death. Respiration may be defined as the mechanical process of breathing in and out. It involves both the respiratory system and muscles of the respiration.

Two phases of breathing are:

- Inhalation – during which the air is drawn into the lungs
- Exhalation – which refers to the expulsion of air from the alveoli
- The respiration is controlled by medulla oblongata

IMPORTANCE OF RESPIRATION



- It supplies oxygen and eliminates carbon dioxide
- It excretes volatile substance like ammonia, ketone bodies, essential oils, alcohol and water vapour etc.,
- By adjusting the amount of carbon dioxide elimination it helps to maintain the normal body temperature.
- It is necessary for the maintenance of optimal oxidation – reduction process in the body.

STUDENT'S ACTIVITY

1. Working model – Lung
2. Deep breathing exercise - inhalation and exhalation by balloon blow method.

2.9 EXCRETORY SYSTEM

INTRODUCTION

The end products of metabolism which have to be removed from the body are called excreta and the organs that remove them are called excretory organs.

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